Physics 1B Formula Sheet

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Contents

1 Introduction **2**

2 Oscillations **2**

2.1 Simple Harmonic Oscillations 2

2.2 Damped Oscillations 2

2.3 Forced Oscillations 3

2.4 Symbols - Oscillations 4

3 Traveling Waves **4**

3.1 General Equation 5

3.2 Superposition 5

3.3 Resonance 6

3.4 Beats 6

1 Introduction

This document is a quick reference for all PHYSICS 1B relevant equations, organized both by type and topic. This was made specifically for Dr. Corbin's Winter 2026 PHYSICS 1B lecture.

2 Oscillations

The following contains general forms of various differential equations for oscillations.

2.1 Simple Harmonic Oscillations

The second order differential equation regarding *simple harmonic oscillations (SHO/SHM)* has the following general form:

General Form for Simple Harmonic Oscillations

$$\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} + \omega_0^2 x = 0$$

This equation has the following general solutions:

- $x(t) = A\cos(\omega_0 t + \phi)$
- $x(t) = A\sin(\omega_0 t + \phi)$
- $x(t) = a\cos(\omega_0 t) + b\sin(\omega_0 t)$
- $x(t) = Ae^{i(\omega_0 t + \phi)}$
- $x(t) = Ae^{-i(\omega_0 t + \delta)}$

The most important and useful solution to remember is:

General Solution for Simple Harmonic Oscillations

$$x(t) = A\cos(\omega_0 t + \phi)$$

2.2 Damped Oscillations

The second order differential equation regarding *damped oscillations* has the following general form:

General Form for Damped Oscillations

$$\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} + 2\beta\frac{dx}{dt} + \omega_0^2 x = 0$$

General Solution for Damped Oscillations

$$x(t) = A_0 e^{-\beta t}\cos(\sqrt{\omega_0^2 - \beta^2 t} + \phi)$$

$$x(t) = A(t)\cos(\omega t + \phi)$$

$$A(t) = A_0 e^{-\beta t}, \quad \omega = \sqrt{\omega_0^2 - \beta^2}$$

$$T = \frac{2\pi}{\sqrt{\omega_0^2 - \beta^2}}$$

2.3 Forced Oscillations

The second order differential equation regarding *forced oscillations* has the following general form:

General Form for Forced Oscillations

$$\frac{d^2x}{dt^2} + 2\beta\frac{dx}{dt} + \omega_0^2 x = F\cos(\Omega t)$$

General Solution for Forced Oscillations

$$x(t) = A_0 e^{-\beta t}\cos(\omega t + \phi) + \frac{F}{\sqrt{(\omega_0^2 - \Omega^2)^2 + (2\beta\Omega)^2}}\cos(\Omega t + \xi)$$

Particular Solution:

$$x_{\text{part}}(t) = A(t)cos(\Omega t + \xi)$$

$$A(t) = \frac{F}{\sqrt{(\omega_0^2 - \Omega^2)^2 + (2\beta\Omega)^2}}, \quad \omega = \sqrt{\omega_0^2 - \beta^2}$$

Homogeneous Solution:

$$x_{\text{homog}}(t) = A_0 e^{-\beta t} \cos(\omega t + \phi)$$

Complete General Solution:

$$x(t) = x_{\text{homog}} + x_{\text{part}}$$

2.4 Symbols - Oscillations

- A = Amplitude
  - $A \geq 0$
  - Magnitude of the maximum displacement of the system from equilibrium
- ω_0 = Natural Angular Frequency
  - Rate at which the system passes through phase
  - A constant that converts time to phase
- ϕ = Phase Shift
  - Mathematically shifts the sinusoid in phase (time) to match the physical motion of the oscillator
- $(\omega_0 t + \phi)$ = Phase
  - Angular argument to sinusoid (in radians)
- T = Period (Time for one complete cycle)
  - $T = \frac{2\pi}{\omega_0}$
- f = Frequency (# of cycles transited in unit time)
  - $f = \frac{1}{T} = \frac{\omega_0}{2\pi}$

3 Traveling Waves

The following contains equations for traveling waves.

3.1 General Equation

General Form for Traveling Waves

$$f(x) = A\sin(kx - \omega t + \phi)$$

The above form has the following associated equations:

- $k = \frac{2\pi}{\lambda}$
- $\omega = \frac{2\pi}{T}$
- $\omega = kv_x$
- $f = \frac{1}{T} \rightarrow f\lambda = v_x$

Speed at which disturbances propagate through different media:

- String: $v_x = \sqrt{\frac{T}{\mu}}$;—; T = tension, μ = linear mass density
- Solid: $v_x = \sqrt{\frac{\beta}{\rho}}$;—; β = bulk modulus, ρ = volume mass density
- Gas: $v_x = \sqrt{\frac{\gamma P_0}{\rho_0}}$;—; γ = ratio of specific heats, P_0 = undisturbed, nominal pressure, ρ_0 = volume mass density

3.2 Superposition

Superposition/Sum of Medium Displacements

$$y_R(x,t) = \sum y_i(x,t)$$

Identical Waves in Opposite Directions

$$y_R(x,t) = 2A\sin(kx + \frac{\phi_1 + \phi_2}{2})\cos(\omega t + \frac{\phi_2 - \phi_1}{2})$$

$$*y_R(x,t) = 2A\sin(kx)\cos(\omega t)$$

*Assumes origins in space and time such that the phase-shifts are zero.

3.3 Resonance

Resonant Frequencies

$$f_{N,like} = N\frac{v_x}{2L}$$

$$f_{N,mixed} = (2N+1)\frac{v_x}{4L}$$

3.4 Beats

Wave Equation of Beats

$$y_R(x,t) \approx 2A\cos(\delta\omega t)\sin(\omega_{avg}t)$$

$$\delta\omega = \frac{\omega_1 - \omega_2}{2},\ \omega_{avg} = \frac{\omega_1 + \omega_2}{2}$$

*$2A\cos$: Amplitude envelope, sin: Rapid oscillations

Frequency Equation of Beats

$$f_{beat} = \frac{\delta\omega}{\pi} = |f_1 - f_2|$$

3.5 Doppler Effect

THE Equation

$$\frac{f_{obs}}{f_{src}} = \frac{v_{snd} - v_{obs}}{v_{snd} - v_{src}}$$

4 Electricity

4.1 Coulomb's Law

Coulomb's Law-Electric Force

$$\vec{F}_E = k\frac{q_1 q_2}{r^2}\hat{r} = \frac{q_1 q_2}{4\pi\epsilon_0 r^2}\hat{r}$$